



The 2026 College Reality Checklist

5 Marketing Traps to Avoid Before Paying Admission Fees

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A Note From the Founder

"Every year, lakhs of students and parents make life-altering decisions based on polished college brochures, paid influencer reviews, and inflated placement figures. Run your prospective college through this 5-point reality check before booking a seat."

CHECKPOINT 01

1. The "Average Package" Distortion

MARKETING CLAIM

"Our average package is ₹8.5 LPA!"

GROUND REALITY

Average numbers are skewed by 1 or 2 extreme offers. If 9 students get ₹3 LPA and 1 gets ₹50 LPA, the average becomes ₹7.7 LPA—even though 90% earn far less.

WHAT TO ASK FOR:

Always demand the **Median Package** (check NIRF reports). The median represents what the middle student actually earns.

CHECKPOINT 02

2. The "100% Placements" Illusion

MARKETING CLAIM

"100% Placement Record for Eligible Students!"

GROUND REALITY

Colleges strictly filter "eligibility." If 300 out of 500 students are disqualified due to attendance or CGPA, placing 200 out of 200 is touted as 100%.

WHAT TO CHECK:

Compare the total batch size against the actual number of placed students, not just the "registered" list.

CHECKPOINT 03

3. The "Highest Package" PR Stunt

MARKETING CLAIM

"Highest International Package: ₹45 LPA!"

GROUND REALITY

Often an off-campus offer achieved independently by an exceptional student, or a 4-year multi-year CTC loaded with stocks and one-off bonuses.

💡 WHAT TO CHECK:

A ₹45 LPA CTC often equals ₹12–14 LPA base salary in hand. Always ask for the base in-hand salary range.

CHECKPOINT 04

4. Hidden Campus Costs & Fine Print

MARKETING CLAIM

"Tuition & Hostel Fee: ₹2.5 Lakhs/year"

GROUND REALITY

Mandatory exam fees, degree charges, AC electricity surcharges, and non-refundable deposits are added after you join.

💡 WHAT TO REQUEST:

Ask the admission cell for an **Itemized Fee Structure** covering all 4 years with explicitly listed extras.

CHECKPOINT 05

5. The 3 Questions You MUST Ask Current Seniors

Reach out to 3-5 current 3rd or 4th-year students on LinkedIn and send a polite DM asking:

1. "How many companies actually visited campus this year offering above ₹6 LPA in-hand?"
2. "How strict is the attendance policy, and are faculty supportive of projects & internships?"
3. "What is one thing you wish you knew before joining this college?"

Help Us Uncover the Truth

Have insights or real experiences from your campus? Help future students make informed decisions.

[Visit CollegeGroundReality.com](https://collegergroundreality.com) to submit an anonymous review